

1 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 10 minutes

Three pets, two clues

What we are practising

Combine clues to find a unique one-to-one match.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Use spoken names and point to drawn animals.

Before you begin

Write Sami, Noor and Huda; each has one different pet: cat, bird or fish.

All characters are fictional; no pets are needed for this activity.

Try it together

1. Draw a grid with the names as rows and animals as columns.
2. Use these clues: Sami has the fish; Noor does not have the bird.
3. Cross out impossible matches and fill the remaining ones.
4. Check that every animal and every child appears exactly once.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Which clue should you use first, and why?

Space to explore

2 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

Two sorting rules

What we are practising

Classify items that meet both, one or neither of two rules.

What you need

Paper / Two coloured pencils

Write R or B inside shapes instead of using colours.

Before you begin

Draw two overlapping circles labelled red and triangle.

Use labels as well as colours so colour recognition is not required.

Try it together

1. Draw a red triangle, blue triangle, red square and blue square beside the circles.
2. Copy each shape into the place matching its properties.
3. Explain why one shape belongs in the overlap.
4. Invent a new shape for each region, including outside both circles.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Where does a blue square belong?

Space to explore

3 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

Robot on a grid

What we are practising

Sequence commands and locate the first instruction that causes an error.

What you need

Paper / Pencil / Large paper marker

Move a fingertip instead of a marker.

Before you begin

Draw a 4 by 4 grid; mark start at bottom left, goal at top right and a blocked square directly above start.

Keep the robot on paper; no blindfolded walking is needed.

Try it together

1. Agree that each command moves one square up, down, left or right on the page.
2. Write commands to reach the goal without entering the blocked square.
3. Ask a partner to follow the commands literally.
4. If it fails, change the first incorrect command and test again.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What changes if the first command is up?

Space to explore

4 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 10 minutes

Find a rule, test a rule

What we are practising

Apply a consistent rule while recognizing that a short pattern may have several explanations.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Say the sequence aloud and count with fingers.

Before you begin

Write 2, 5, 8, 11 and leave two blanks.

Allow thinking time and accept explained alternative rules.

Try it together

1. Compare each pair of neighbours.
2. Choose one rule that fits every shown step.
3. Use that rule to fill the blanks and check backward.
4. Create another four-number pattern for a partner.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What evidence supports your rule?

Space to explore

5 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

The snack-box order

What we are practising

Combine first, last and immediately-before relationships.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Use four large folded paper cards.

Before you begin

Label four drawn boxes apple, bread, carrot and dates; positions run left to right.

Use drawn food; no tasting or food preparation is involved.

Try it together

1. Draw four numbered positions from 1 to 4.
2. Use the clues: apple is first; dates is last; bread is immediately before carrot.
3. Place the boxes and read every clue again.
4. Explain why swapping the middle two boxes fails.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Does before always mean immediately before?

Space to explore

6 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 10 minutes

The three-day workshop

What we are practising

Combine ordering constraints.

What you need

Paper / Pencil or crayons

An adult can describe the scene aloud and accept a spoken or pointed answer. No printer is needed.

Before you begin

Write Monday, Tuesday and Wednesday; schedule drawing, building and storytelling once each.

Explore the situation on paper with suitable drawing tools. Ask an adult before trying a real-world investigation.

Try it together

1. Write Monday, Tuesday and Wednesday; schedule drawing, building and storytelling once each.
2. Ask: Building is after drawing; storytelling is before drawing. What is the schedule?
3. Choose or draw an answer. Explain it using the clues; check the explanation together after trying.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Write Monday, Tuesday and Wednesday; schedule drawing, building and storytelling once each.

Building is after drawing; storytelling is before drawing. What is the schedule?

Space to explore

7 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 10 minutes

A claim needs a counterexample

What we are practising

Test an all-statement with evidence.

What you need

Paper / Pencil or crayons

An adult can describe the scene aloud and accept a spoken or pointed answer. No printer is needed.

Before you begin

Draw two red circles and one blue circle.

Explore the situation on paper with suitable drawing tools. Ask an adult before trying a real-world investigation.

Try it together

1. Draw two red circles and one blue circle.
2. Ask: Someone says “Every circle here is red.” Which picture disproves the claim?
3. Choose or draw an answer. Explain it using the clues; check the explanation together after trying.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Draw two red circles and one blue circle. Someone says “Every circle here is red.” Which picture disproves the claim?

Space to explore

8 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 10 minutes

The row-and-column address

What we are practising

Track two coordinates.

What you need

Paper / Pencil or crayons

An adult can describe the scene aloud and accept a spoken or pointed answer. No printer is needed.

Before you begin

Draw a three-by-three grid; label rows top to bottom A,B,C and columns left to right 1,2,3.

Explore the situation on paper with suitable drawing tools. Ask an adult before trying a real-world investigation.

Try it together

1. Draw a three-by-three grid; label rows top to bottom A,B,C and columns left to right 1,2,3.
2. Ask: A star is in B2. Move it one row down and one column left. Where does it arrive?
3. Choose or draw an answer. Explain it using the clues; check the explanation together after trying.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Draw a three-by-three grid; label rows top to bottom A,B,C and columns left to right 1,2,3. A star is in B2. Move it one row down and one column left. Where does it arrive?

Space to explore

9 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 10 minutes

One shape breaks the rule

What we are practising

Apply a precise classification rule.

What you need

Paper / Pencil or crayons

An adult can describe the scene aloud and accept a spoken or pointed answer. No printer is needed.

Before you begin

Draw a square, rectangle, trapezoid and triangle.

Explore the situation on paper with suitable drawing tools. Ask an adult before trying a real-world investigation.

Try it together

1. Draw a square, rectangle, trapezoid and triangle.
2. Ask: The collection rule is “exactly four straight sides”. Which shape must leave?
3. Choose or draw an answer. Explain it using the clues; check the explanation together after trying.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Draw a square, rectangle, trapezoid and triangle. The collection rule is “exactly four straight sides”. Which shape must leave?

Space to explore

10 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 10 minutes

The symbol message

What we are practising

Decode with a consistent key.

What you need

Paper / Pencil or crayons

An adult can describe the scene aloud and accept a spoken or pointed answer. No printer is needed.

Before you begin

Make a key: star means jump, circle means clap, square means turn.

Explore the situation on paper with suitable drawing tools. Ask an adult before trying a real-world investigation.

Try it together

1. Make a key: star means jump, circle means clap, square means turn.
2. Ask: Read star, square, circle in that order. What is the message?
3. Choose or draw an answer. Explain it using the clues; check the explanation together after trying.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Make a key: star means jump, circle means clap, square means turn. Read star, square, circle in that order. What is the message?

Space to explore

11 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 10 minutes

The heavier pretend parcel

What we are practising

Use an equal result to eliminate possibilities.

What you need

Paper / Pencil or crayons

An adult can describe the scene aloud and accept a spoken or pointed answer. No printer is needed.

Before you begin

Draw parcels A,B,C; exactly one is heavier and the other two weigh the same.

Explore the situation on paper with suitable drawing tools. Ask an adult before trying a real-world investigation.

Try it together

1. Draw parcels A,B,C; exactly one is heavier and the other two weigh the same.
2. Ask: A balance comparing A and B stays level. Which parcel is heavier?
3. Choose or draw an answer. Explain it using the clues; check the explanation together after trying.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Draw parcels A,B,C; exactly one is heavier and the other two weigh the same. A balance comparing A and B stays level. Which parcel is heavier?

Space to explore

12 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 10 minutes

Guaranteed matching socks

What we are practising

Reason about a guaranteed result.

What you need

Paper / Pencil or crayons

An adult can describe the scene aloud and accept a spoken or pointed answer. No printer is needed.

Before you begin

Imagine a drawer containing only red and blue socks, with plenty of each.

Explore the situation on paper with suitable drawing tools. Ask an adult before trying a real-world investigation.

Try it together

1. Imagine a drawer containing only red and blue socks, with plenty of each.
2. Ask: Without looking, how many socks guarantee at least two of the same colour?
3. Choose or draw an answer. Explain it using the clues; check the explanation together after trying.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Imagine a drawer containing only red and blue socks, with plenty of each. Without looking, how many socks guarantee at least two of the same colour?

Space to explore

13 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 10 minutes

Check the packing report

What we are practising

Verify statements against a record.

What you need

Paper / Pencil or crayons

An adult can describe the scene aloud and accept a spoken or pointed answer. No printer is needed.

Before you begin

Draw a bag list: two books, one pencil, no ball.

Explore the situation on paper with suitable drawing tools. Ask an adult before trying a real-world investigation.

Try it together

1. Draw a bag list: two books, one pencil, no ball.
2. Ask: Which report is false: “a pencil is packed”, “a ball is packed”, “two books are packed”?
3. Choose or draw an answer. Explain it using the clues; check the explanation together after trying.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Draw a bag list: two books, one pencil, no ball. Which report is false: “a pencil is packed”, “a ball is packed”, “two books are packed”?

Space to explore

14 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 10 minutes

The one-way arrows

What we are practising

Follow directed connections with a restriction.

What you need

Paper / Pencil or crayons

An adult can describe the scene aloud and accept a spoken or pointed answer. No printer is needed.

Before you begin

Draw arrows A to B, B to D, A to C, C to A; no other arrows.

Explore the situation on paper with suitable drawing tools. Ask an adult before trying a real-world investigation.

Try it together

1. Draw arrows A to B, B to D, A to C, C to A; no other arrows.
2. Ask: Starting at A without revisiting a point, how can you reach D following arrows?
3. Choose or draw an answer. Explain it using the clues; check the explanation together after trying.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Draw arrows A to B, B to D, A to C, C to A; no other arrows. Starting at A without revisiting a point, how can you reach D following arrows?

Space to explore

15 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 10 minutes

Reverse the carriages

What we are practising

Apply an operation to a specified part.

What you need

Paper / Pencil or crayons

An adult can describe the scene aloud and accept a spoken or pointed answer. No printer is needed.

Before you begin

Draw a train ordered engine, red, blue, green from left to right.

Explore the situation on paper with suitable drawing tools. Ask an adult before trying a real-world investigation.

Try it together

1. Draw a train ordered engine, red, blue, green from left to right.
2. Ask: Reverse only the three coloured carriages, leaving the engine first. What follows the engine now?
3. Choose or draw an answer. Explain it using the clues; check the explanation together after trying.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Draw a train ordered engine, red, blue, green from left to right. Reverse only the three coloured carriages, leaving the engine first. What follows the engine now?

Space to explore

16 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 10 minutes

Four pictures, two questions

What we are practising

Narrow choices with successive questions.

What you need

Paper / Pencil or crayons

An adult can describe the scene aloud and accept a spoken or pointed answer. No printer is needed.

Before you begin

Draw red circle, blue circle, red square, blue square.

Explore the situation on paper with suitable drawing tools. Ask an adult before trying a real-world investigation.

Try it together

1. Draw red circle, blue circle, red square, blue square.
2. Ask: A chosen picture is red but is not a circle. Which is it?
3. Choose or draw an answer. Explain it using the clues; check the explanation together after trying.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Draw red circle, blue circle, red square, blue square. A chosen picture is red but is not a circle. Which is it?

Space to explore

17 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 10 minutes

A machine that swaps

What we are practising

Execute a two-step algorithm.

What you need

Paper / Pencil or crayons

An adult can describe the scene aloud and accept a spoken or pointed answer. No printer is needed.

Before you begin

Write A B C from left to right. The machine swaps the first two, then the last two.

Explore the situation on paper with suitable drawing tools. Ask an adult before trying a real-world investigation.

Try it together

1. Write A B C from left to right. The machine swaps the first two, then the last two.
2. Ask: What order comes out after both swaps?
3. Choose or draw an answer. Explain it using the clues; check the explanation together after trying.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Write A B C from left to right. The machine swaps the first two, then the last two. What order comes out after both swaps?

Space to explore

18 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 10 minutes

The missing instruction

What we are practising

Debug a missing prerequisite in instructions.

What you need

Paper / Pencil or crayons

An adult can describe the scene aloud and accept a spoken or pointed answer. No printer is needed.

Before you begin

A drawing robot is told: draw a circle, colour the square blue. No square exists yet.

Explore the situation on paper with suitable drawing tools. Ask an adult before trying a real-world investigation.

Try it together

1. A drawing robot is told: draw a circle, colour the square blue. No square exists yet.
2. Ask: What instruction is missing before colouring the square?
3. Choose or draw an answer. Explain it using the clues; check the explanation together after trying.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A drawing robot is told: draw a circle, colour the square blue. No square exists yet. What instruction is missing before colouring the square?

Space to explore

19 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 10 minutes

Could both be right?

What we are practising

Distinguish some from all.

What you need

Paper / Pencil or crayons

An adult can describe the scene aloud and accept a spoken or pointed answer. No printer is needed.

Before you begin

A box contains only triangles and circles, with at least one of each.

Explore the situation on paper with suitable drawing tools. Ask an adult before trying a real-world investigation.

Try it together

1. A box contains only triangles and circles, with at least one of each.
2. Ask: Can “some shapes are circles” and “not every shape is a circle” both be true?
3. Choose or draw an answer. Explain it using the clues; check the explanation together after trying.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A box contains only triangles and circles, with at least one of each. Can “some shapes are circles” and “not every shape is a circle” both be true?

Space to explore

20 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 10 minutes

The silent extra clue

What we are practising

Detect insufficient information.

What you need

Paper / Pencil or crayons

An adult can describe the scene aloud and accept a spoken or pointed answer. No printer is needed.

Before you begin

Three shapes are red circle, blue circle and blue square; the chosen shape is blue.

Explore the situation on paper with suitable drawing tools. Ask an adult before trying a real-world investigation.

Try it together

1. Three shapes are red circle, blue circle and blue square; the chosen shape is blue.
2. Ask: Does the blue clue alone identify one shape? What further clue would help?
3. Choose or draw an answer. Explain it using the clues; check the explanation together after trying.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Three shapes are red circle, blue circle and blue square; the chosen shape is blue. Does the blue clue alone identify one shape? What further clue would help?

Space to explore

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

1. Three pets, two clues

A little hint

Once Sami has the fish, only cat and bird remain for the others.

Answer / what to notice

Sami has the fish, Noor has the cat and Huda has the bird.

Noor cannot have the used fish or the forbidden bird, so she has the cat; Huda gets the remaining bird.

Make it easier

Remove Sami and solve only the cat-or-bird choice.

Take it further

Write a new set of clues with a different unique answer.

Another day, away from the screen

Create a matching puzzle about three bags and three colours.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

2. Two sorting rules

A little hint

The overlap means red AND triangular.

Answer / what to notice

Red triangle: overlap. Blue triangle: triangle only. Red square: red only. Blue square: outside both.

An item belongs in a circle only when it meets that circle's rule.

Make it easier

Start with separate groups for red and blue.

Take it further

Replace colour with size and define a clear size cutoff.

Another day, away from the screen

Sort imagined animals by has wings and lives mainly in water.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

3. Robot on a grid

A little hint

Move right before moving up to avoid the blocked square.

Answer / what to notice

One shortest route is right, right, right, up, up, up; it uses six moves.

The goal is three columns right and three rows up, so fewer than six moves cannot reach it.

Make it easier

Use a 3 by 3 grid without a blocked square.

Take it further

Add a second obstacle and find two different shortest routes.

Another day, away from the screen

Give a pretend robot instructions to arrange three drawn books.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

4. Find a rule, test a rule

A little hint

Subtract each number from the next one.

Answer / what to notice

Using add 3 gives 14 and 17. Other explicitly stated rules may also fit the short sequence.

Each shown gap is 3; stating the rule makes the prediction checkable without claiming it is the only possible rule.

Make it easier

Use 2, 4, 6, 8 and count pairs.

Take it further

Try a repeating rule such as add 2, then add 5.

Another day, away from the screen

Make a repeating pattern with claps and taps and state its rule.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

5. The snack-box order

A little hint

After filling the two ends, only positions 2 and 3 remain.

Answer / what to notice

From left to right: apple, bread, carrot, dates.

The fixed ends leave two spaces, and the immediate-before clue fixes their order.

Make it easier

Place the first and last boxes for the child.

Take it further

Remove the last-position clue and find every order still allowed.

Another day, away from the screen

Create a new four-item order and give a partner enough clues to solve it.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

6. The three-day workshop

A little hint

Drawing needs a day on either side.

Answer / what to notice

Monday storytelling, Tuesday drawing, Wednesday building.

The two before/after clues force drawing into the middle.

Make it easier

Place drawing on Tuesday first.

Take it further

Add Thursday and explain why the same clues no longer give one complete schedule.

Another day, away from the screen

On another day, draw your own version of this challenge and explain which details must stay the same for the answer to work.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

7. A claim needs a counterexample

A little hint

One exception is enough to challenge “every”.

Answer / what to notice

The blue circle.

It is a circle that is not red, so the universal claim is false.

Make it easier

Ask whether the blue shape is a circle.

Take it further

Rewrite the claim so it is true without removing a picture.

Another day, away from the screen

On another day, draw your own version of this challenge and explain which details must stay the same for the answer to work.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

8. The row-and-column address

A little hint

Change the row and column separately.

Answer / what to notice

C1: bottom-left.

Down changes B to C; left changes 2 to 1.

Make it easier

Mark the intermediate square C2.

Take it further

Reverse the moves and check that the star returns to B2.

Another day, away from the screen

On another day, draw your own version of this challenge and explain which details must stay the same for the answer to work.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

9. One shape breaks the rule

A little hint

Count sides rather than judging appearance.

Answer / what to notice

The triangle.

It has three sides; the other drawn shapes have four.

Make it easier

Mark a dot on each side as you count.

Take it further

Draw an irregular four-sided shape and explain why it still belongs.

Another day, away from the screen

On another day, draw your own version of this challenge and explain which details must stay the same for the answer to work.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

10. The symbol message

A little hint

Replace one symbol at a time.

Answer / what to notice

Jump, turn, clap; saying the actions is enough.

The key fixes each symbol's meaning, while order fixes the message.

Make it easier

Keep the key beside each symbol.

Take it further

Encode “clap, clap, turn” and have someone decode it.

Another day, away from the screen

On another day, draw your own version of this challenge and explain which details must stay the same for the answer to work.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

11. The heavier pretend parcel

A little hint

A level balance rules out a difference between A and B.

Answer / what to notice

C.

Neither A nor B can be the unique heavier one, so C remains.

Make it easier

Mark A and B with matching weight symbols.

Take it further

Explain the answer if A's side drops instead.

Another day, away from the screen

On another day, draw your own version of this challenge and explain which details must stay the same for the answer to work.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

12. Guaranteed matching socks

A little hint

The first two could be different.

Answer / what to notice

Three socks.

If the first two differ, the third must match one of their two colours.

Make it easier

Draw one red and one blue, then test both choices for the third.

Take it further

Add green socks and find the new guarantee: four.

Another day, away from the screen

On another day, draw your own version of this challenge and explain which details must stay the same for the answer to work.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

13. Check the packing report

A little hint

Compare every report with the list.

Answer / what to notice

“A ball is packed” is false.

The list explicitly says there is no ball.

Make it easier

Cross out the ball report together.

Take it further

Change one item in the list so exactly two reports become false.

Another day, away from the screen

On another day, draw your own version of this challenge and explain which details must stay the same for the answer to work.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

14. The one-way arrows

A little hint

C sends you back to a visited point.

Answer / what to notice

A, then B, then D.

The C branch returns to A; only B leads forward to D.

Make it easier

Trace the outgoing arrows from A.

Take it further

Add an arrow C to D; identify the new valid route.

Another day, away from the screen

On another day, draw your own version of this challenge and explain which details must stay the same for the answer to work.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

15. Reverse the carriages

A little hint

Reverse the chosen section, not the whole row.

Answer / what to notice

Green, blue, red.

Reversal swaps the outer carriages while the middle remains in the middle.

Make it easier

Cover the engine while reversing the colours.

Take it further

Reverse the same section again and explain why the original order returns.

Another day, away from the screen

On another day, draw your own version of this challenge and explain which details must stay the same for the answer to work.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

16. Four pictures, two questions

A little hint

Keep red choices, then remove circles.

Answer / what to notice

The red square.

The colour removes two blue shapes; the second clue removes the red circle.

Make it easier

Cover each rejected picture.

Take it further

Design two yes/no questions that identify any of the four pictures.

Another day, away from the screen

On another day, draw your own version of this challenge and explain which details must stay the same for the answer to work.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

17. A machine that swaps

A little hint

Record the intermediate row.

Answer / what to notice

B C A, from left to right.

A B C becomes B A C, then B C A.

Make it easier

Draw an arrow between the two positions being swapped.

Take it further

Swap the last two first, then the first two; compare results.

Another day, away from the screen

On another day, draw your own version of this challenge and explain which details must stay the same for the answer to work.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

18. The missing instruction

A little hint

The object must exist before it can be coloured.

Answer / what to notice

Draw a square.

The colouring command refers to a shape the program has never created.

Make it easier

Act as the robot and stop at the impossible step.

Take it further

Write a complete four-step program for two coloured shapes.

Another day, away from the screen

On another day, draw your own version of this challenge and explain which details must stay the same for the answer to work.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

19. Could both be right?

A little hint

One triangle prevents all shapes being circles.

Answer / what to notice

Yes.

Circles make the first claim true; triangles make the second true.

Make it easier

Draw just one circle and one triangle.

Take it further

Give a box that makes the first claim true and the second false.

Another day, away from the screen

On another day, draw your own version of this challenge and explain which details must stay the same for the answer to work.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

20. The silent extra clue

A little hint

Count how many choices survive.

Answer / what to notice

No. “It is a square” would identify the blue square; “it is a circle” would identify the blue circle.

A clue can be correct but insufficient to produce one answer.

Make it easier

Cover the red circle and compare what remains.

Take it further

Invent a true additional clue that still fails to separate the two.

Another day, away from the screen

On another day, draw your own version of this challenge and explain which details must stay the same for the answer to work.